

browsing experience can be an incentive enough. There are phones which offer both a touch screen combined with a regular numpad or QWERTY keypad.

GPS is the most accurate location aware method available on a phone today or any mobile device

2.2 Internet access

In India, there are more mobiles with access to the internet than desktop computers. Mobiles have become an important and convenient way to access the plethora of information and service that the internet has to offer.

There are three primary ways to access the internet on your mobile phone

GPRS: This is the slowest and the most omnipresent way to access the internet. GPRS stands for General Packet Radio Service. You can expect speeds slightly slower than an old rusty dial-up internet connection of around 4-5 kBps. Suitable only for an occasional search or an urgent mail check. Patience is a virtue over here. GPRS with EDGE (Enhanced Data Rates for GSM Evolution) offers enhanced speeds if your phone and network supports it. Most telecom networks support GPRS in major cities. Browsing becomes a lot more bearable, especially with software such as Opera Mini that offer server-side compression of web pages.

3G (3rd generation): Right now one of the hottest topics in the Indian telecom scene, with public sector operators such as MTNL and BSNL offering them and private players joining the scene it can be an important consideration in deciding which phone to buy. Simply speaking from the end-user perspective 3G is the fastest way of browsing the internet with speeds around 200 kBps+, which

Half-QWERTY keypad offers a compromise between speed and size

effectively means you can stream video, download games and applications at much faster speeds.

Browsing becomes a pleasure, and if your phone has a large screen, you'll enjoy your mobile internet experience. Your phone can also act as a Bluetooth modem enabling you to surf the internet on your laptop while on the move. It even supports video calls; so college students, it is time you tidy up your room before you make that call to your parents.

